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The Threat of a Red Asia

Address by Secretary Dulles [1]

This provides a timely occasion for outlining the administration's thinking about two related matters—Indochina and the Chinese Communist regime.

Indochina is important for many reasons. First, and always first, are the human values. About 30 million people are seeking for themselves the dignity of self-government. Until a few years ago, they formed merely a French dependency. Now, their three political units—Viet-Nam, Laos, and Cambodia—are exercising a considerable measure of independent political authority within the French Union. Each of the three is now recognized by the United States and by more than 30 other nations. They signed the Japanese peace treaty with us. Their independence is not yet complete. But the French Government last July declared its intention to complete that independence, and negotiations to consummate that pledge are actively under way.

The United States is watching this development with close attention and great sympathy. We do not forget that we were a colony that won its freedom. We have sponsored in the Philippines a conspicuously successful development of political independence. We feel a sense of kinship with those everywhere who yearn for freedom.

The Communists are attempting to prevent the orderly development of independence and to confuse the issue before the world. The Communists have, in these matters, a regular line which Stalin laid down in 1924.

The scheme is to whip up the spirit of nationalism so that it becomes violent. That is done by professional agitators. Then the violence is enlarged by Communist military and technical leadership and the provision of military supplies. In these ways, international communism gets a stranglehold on the people and it uses that power to "amalgamate" the peoples into the Soviet orbit.

"Amalgamation" is Lenin's and Stalin's word to describe their process.

[1] Made before the Overseas Press Club of America at New York, N. Y., on Mar. 29 (press release 165).

Communist Imperialism in Indochina

"Amalgamation" is now being attempted in Indochina under the ostensible leadership of Ho Chi Minh. He was indoctrinated in Moscow. He became an associate of the Russian, Borodin, when the latter was organizing the Chinese Communist Party which was to bring China into the Soviet orbit. Then Ho transferred his activities to Indochina.

Those fighting under the banner of Ho Chi Minh have largely been trained and equipped in Communist China. They are supplied with artillery and ammunition through the Soviet-Chinese Communist bloc. Captured matériel shows that much of it was fabricated by the Skoda Munition Works in Czechoslovakia and transported across Russia and Siberia and then sent through China into Viet-Nam. Military supplies for the Communist armies have been pouring into Viet-Nam at a steadily increasing rate.

Military and technical guidance is supplied by an estimated 2,000 Communist Chinese. They function with the forces of Ho Chi Minh in key positions—in staff sections of the High Command, at the division level, and in specialized units such as signal, engineer, artillery, and transportation.

In the present stage, the Communists in Indochina use nationalistic anti-French slogans to win local support. But if they achieved military or political success, it is certain that they would subject the people to a cruel Communist dictatorship taking its orders from Peiping and Moscow.

The Scope of the Danger

The tragedy would not stop there. If the Communist forces won uncontested control over Indochina or any substantial part thereof, they would surely resume the same pattern of aggression against other free peoples in the area.

The propagandists of Red China and Russia make it apparent that the purpose is to dominate all of Southeast Asia.

Southeast Asia is the so-called "rice bowl" which helps to feed the densely populated region that extends from India to Japan. It is rich in

many raw materials, such as tin, oil, rubber, and iron ore. It offers industrial Japan potentially important markets and sources of raw materials.

The area has great strategic value. Southeast Asia is astride the most direct and best-developed sea and air routes between the Pacific and South Asia. It has major naval and air bases. Communist control of Southeast Asia would carry a grave threat to the Philippines, Australia, and New Zealand, with whom we have treaties of mutual assistance. The entire Western Pacific area, including the so-called "offshore island chain," would be strategically endangered.

President Eisenhower appraised the situation last Wednesday [March 24] when he said that the area is of "transcendent importance."

The United States Position

The United States has shown in many ways its sympathy for the gallant struggle being waged in Indochina by French forces and those of the Associated States. Congress has enabled us to provide material aid to the established governments and their peoples. Also, our diplomacy has sought to deter Communist China from open aggression in that area.

President Eisenhower, in his address of April 16, 1953,[2] explained that a Korean armistice would be a fraud if it merely released aggressive armies for attack elsewhere. I said last September [3] that if Red China sent its own army into Indochina, that would result in grave consequences which might not be confined to Indochina.

Recent statements have been designed to impress upon potential aggressors that aggression might lead to action at places and by means of free-world choosing, so that aggression would cost more than it could gain.

The Chinese Communists have, in fact, avoided the direct use of their own Red armies in open aggression against Indochina. They have, however, largely stepped up their support of the aggression in that area. Indeed, they promote that aggression by all means short of open invasion.

Under all the circumstances it seems desirable to clarify further the United States position.

Under the conditions of today, the imposition on Southeast Asia of the political system of Communist Russia and its Chinese Communist ally, by whatever means, would be a grave threat to the whole free community. The United States feels that that possibility should not be passively accepted but should be met by united action. This might involve serious risks. But these risks are far less than those that will face us a few years from now if we dare not be resolute today.

The free nations want peace. However, peace is not had merely by wanting it. Peace has to be worked for and planned for. Sometimes it is necessary to take risks to win peace just as it is necessary in war to take risks to win victory. The chances for peace are usually bettered by letting a potential aggressor know in advance where his aggression could lead him.

I hope that these statements which I make here tonight will serve the cause of peace.

Communist China

Let me now discuss our political relations with Red China, taking first the matter of recognition.

The United States does not recognize the Chinese Communist regime. That is well known. But the reasons seem not so well known. Some think that there are no reasons and that we are actuated purely by emotion. Your Government believes that its position is soberly rational.

Let me first recall that diplomatic recognition is a voluntary act. One country has no right to demand recognition by another. Generally, it is useful that there should be diplomatic intercourse between those who exercise *de facto* governmental authority, and it is well established that recognition does not imply moral approval.

President Monroe, in his famous message to Congress, denounced the expansionist and despotic system of Czarist Russia and its allies. But he said that it would nevertheless be our policy "to consider the government *de facto* as the legitimate government for us." That has indeed been the general United States policy, and I believe that it is a sound general policy. However, where it does not serve our interests, we are free to vary from it.

In relation to Communist China, we are forced to take account of the fact that the Chinese Communist regime has been consistently and viciously hostile to the United States.

A typical Chinese Communist pamphlet reads: "We Must Hate America, because She is the Chinese People's Implacable Enemy." "We Must Despise America because it is a Corrupt Imperialist Nation, the World Center of Reaction and Decadency." "We Must Look down upon America because She is a Paper Tiger and Entirely Vulnerable to Defeat."

By print, by radio, by drama, by pictures, with all the propaganda skills which communism has devised, such themes are propagated by the Red rulers. They vent their hatred by barbarous acts, such as seizures and imprisonments of Americans.

Those responsible for United States policy must ask and answer: "Will it help our country if, by recognition, we give increased prestige and influence to a regime that actively attacks our vital interests?" I can find only the answer: "No."

Let us turn now to the matter of seating Red China in the United Nations. By the charter, membership is supposed to be limited to "peace-loving" states. Therefore, it is relevant to recall

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[2] BULLETIN of Apr. 27, 1953, p. 599.
[3] *Ibid.*, Sept. 14, 1953, p. 339.

that the Chinese Communist regime became an aggressor in the latter part of 1950. Its armies invaded Korea and waged war against the United Nations Command. They contributed largely to the killing, wounding, or losing in action of about 500,000 soldiers of the United Nations Command, including over 100,000 Americans.

The United Nations General Assembly on February 1, 1951, voted, 44 to 7, that the Chinese People's Republic was guilty of aggression in Korea. It called upon it to withdraw its forces from Korea. But they still remain.

It is true that the Chinese Communist Command concluded a Korean Armistice. But that was not a Chinese Communist good will offering. It was something that the United Nations Command won. The Communists signed only after desperate and bloody final efforts had failed to break the Allied line, and only after the United Nations Command had made it apparent that the conflict, if continued, would bring into jeopardy valuable Communist military and industrial assets in nearby Manchuria.

The Chinese Communists' continuing lack of genuine will for peace is being demonstrated in Indochina.

As one of the United Nations members who must pass on representation, we must ask, "Will it serve the interests of world order to bring into the United Nations a regime which is a convicted aggressor, which has not purged itself from that aggression, and which continues to promote the use of force in violation of the principles of the United Nations?" I can find only the answer "No."

Free China on Formosa

There is still another aspect of this China matter. We must not forget that the National Government of China continues to function in Formosa and millions of free Chinese are gathered there under its jurisdiction. It has the allegiance of many more. They have been our loyal friends and allies when, during World War II, we needed each other.

Should the free nations facilitate and encourage the bloody liquidation by the Chinese Communists of these free Chinese on Formosa? To me, again, the only answer is "No."

Experience With Communist Promises

Some say that the United States should recognize the Chinese Communist regime and welcome it to the United Nations, in reliance of promises in relation to Korea and Indochina.

The United States must judge that proposal on the basis of past experience.

The United States agreed to recognize the Soviet regime in 1933 relying on its promise, in the so-called "Litvinov agreement," to avoid and prevent political action from Russia against our political or social order. We performed and granted recognition. But the promises we received were vain.

At Yalta, in February 1945, Britain and the United States gave sanction to the fact of dominant Soviet influence in Central Europe. They did so on the basis of a Soviet agreement that the peoples of liberated Europe would have the right "to choose the form of government under which they will live," and that in Poland there would be "free and unfettered elections as soon as possible." But those promises we received were vain.

There was also a Yalta agreement with reference to the Far East. The United States agreed to obtain for the Soviet Union control of Port Arthur, Dairen, and the Manchurian Railroad. In exchange, the Soviet Union promised to support the National Government of China. This arrangement was consummated at Moscow in August 1945. Then the Soviet Government acquired from China the Manchurian assets that had been promised it. In return it gave a 30-year engagement "to render to China moral support and aid in military supplies and other material resources, such support and aid to be entirely given to the National Government as the central government of China."

Having gained what it wanted, the Soviet Government then moved promptly to assist the Chinese Communist regime in its efforts to overthrow the National Government. It gave to the Chinese Communist forces vast stocks of military supplies and other material resources which it had promised to give entirely to the National Government.

In this matter again we gave performance. But the corresponding Communist promises proved vain.

Our experience with Chinese Communist promises is limited because we have with them only one agreement. That is the Korean Armistice. The United Nations Command has reported that the Communists have violated it 40 times. That only tells part of the story, for the basic violation is that the Swedish and Swiss members of the Supervisory Commission are denied an adequate opportunity to supervise the North and to detect Communist violations.

The United States recognizes that few nations have a record which is not marred by some violations of agreements. Also, we recognize that nothing human is immutable. Surely, there is nothing vindictive or implacable about the American people. Indeed, few people are as ready as we to forgive and forget. But it would be reckless for us to ignore the events of recent years which have filled our archives with vain promises. We are not in the market for more.

It is now the policy of the United States not to exchange United States performance for Communist promises.

That United States position was made clear at the recent Berlin conference. There, by standing firm, I finally obtained the reluctant agreement by Mr. Molotov that the Geneva conference would not be a "Big Five Conference" and that the invitation to Geneva would itself specify that neither the invitation to, nor the holding of, that conference should be deemed to imply diplomatic recognition where it had not already been accorded.

The Chinese Communist regime has been invited only to discuss Korea and Indochina, where it is in fact a force of aggression which we cannot ignore. It gets no diplomatic recognition from us by the fact of its presence at Geneva. I said at Berlin: "It is . . . one thing to recognize evil as a fact. It is another thing to take evil to one's breast and call it good." That we shall not do.

The Dangers Ahead

The United States delegation will go to Geneva in an effort to bring about a united and independent Korea, from which Communist China will have withdrawn its army of invasion. Also, we hope that any Indochina discussion will serve to bring the Chinese Communists to see the danger of their apparent design for the conquest of Southeast Asia, so that they will cease and desist. We shall not, however, be disposed to give Communist China what it wants from us, merely to buy its promises of future good behavior.

Some, perhaps, would have it otherwise. But we dare not forget that during the period when we accepted Communist promises at their face value, and took for granted their peaceful intentions, the danger steadily grew.

We can, I think, take a lesson from Dien-Bien-Phu. For some days there has seemed to be a lull. But in fact the danger has steadily mounted. The enemy sappers have never ceased their work. They have burrowed and tunneled to gain forward positions so that the inner citadels can be subjected to mass assault from close positions.

Today the free world also feels a sense of lull. The danger of general war seems to have receded. I hope that that is so. If it is so, it is because the free nations saw the danger and moved unitedly, with courage and decision, to meet it.

There is, however, no reason for assuming that the danger has permanently passed. There is nothing to prove that the Soviet Communist rulers accept peace as permanent, if permanent peace would block their ambitions. They continue unceasingly to burrow and tunnel to advance their positions against the citadels of freedom.

In Europe, Soviet Russia holds its grip on Eastern Germany and Austria and maneuvers recklessly to prevent reconciliation between France and Germany. In Asia, the whole area from Japan and Korea to Southeast Asia is troubled by Communist efforts at penetration.

As against such efforts, there is only one defense—eternal vigilance, sound policies, and high courage.

The United States is a member of a goodly company who in the past have stood together in the face of great peril and have overcome it. If we are true to that past, we can face the future with hope and confidence.

Tribute to Commander and Men of Dien-Bien-Phu Garrison

President Eisenhower on March 28 sent the following message to René Coty, President of France:

MY DEAR MR. PRESIDENT: In common with millions of my countrymen, I salute the gallantry and stamina of the commander [1] and soldiers who are defending Dien-Bien-Phu. We have the most profound admiration for the brave and resourceful fight being waged there by troops from France, Vietnam, and other parts of the French Union. Those soldiers, true to their own great traditions, are defending the cause of human freedom and are demonstrating in the truest fashion qualities on which the survival of the free world depends. I would be grateful if you would convey to the commander of the gallant garrison of Dien-Bien-Phu this expression of my admiration and best wishes.

DWIGHT D. EISENHOWER.

[1] Col. Christian de Castries.

Considerations Underlying U.S.-China Policy

by Edwin W. Martin
Deputy Director, Office of Chinese Affairs [1]

It is a real privilege for me to be able to meet with you of the China Committee today and to take a small part in your annual meeting. It has been a pleasure to renew acquaintances with many of you and to meet others for the first time. This association is particularly stimulating to me, for it is seldom that those of us in the Department of State who are primarily concerned with Chinese affairs have an opportunity to foregather with such a large group of people who also have a major interest in China. I can assure you I have learned much here today.

I hope that I also have something to contribute, although I must confess that I face you with some trepidation, knowing that many, if not most of you, have lived in China several times as long as I and have been closely following events in China for many more years. On the other hand, because you are a specialized audience, I do not have to explain how complex and difficult a subject China is, nor apologize because I cannot present to you a simple formula for solving what is sometimes called "the China problem."

The only distinction which I might perhaps claim in this gathering of older and wiser China hands is the dubious one of having had the most recent direct contact with officials of the present mainland regime. As a member of Ambassador Dean's Mission, I sat across a narrow table from Chinese and North Korean Communist officials day after day for a period of 7 weeks and, later on, after Mr. Dean returned to this country, during another series of lower-level meetings.

I would not recommend such an experience for pleasure, and I am not sure how much insight into what makes the Communists tick we gained from these formal, cold, and often acrimonious, discussions. However, I did come away with a strong impression that the men who run Communist China dwell in another world from us, live by an entirely different set of standards, and appear to have no genuine interest in working out mutually acceptable solutions to the specific problems, such as those of a divided Korea, which are causing the current tensions in the Far East.

The Geneva Conference

The forthcoming conference at Geneva, however, will give us an opportunity once again to test Chinese Communist intentions. Our agreement to this conference has led to considerable discussion in the press and in other public forums as to its significance in terms of our China policy. The question is asked: Does our agreement to sit down at Geneva with representatives of the Peiping regime mean that our policy on China has changed or is about to change?

The answer is definitely no. The Soviet attempt at Berlin to bring about a so-called five-power conference was categorically rejected by the three Western Foreign Ministers. Instead, an agreement was finally accepted by the Soviets to hold a conference on Korea along the lines proposed in the U.N. General Assembly resolution of August 28, 1953,[2] which was based on the Armistice Agreement and supported by the United States. The Peiping regime will participate in this conference solely as one of the belligerents in Korea. Its status will be no different from that of its fellow aggressor, the North Korean regime. It must be dealt with because of its involvement in Korean affairs.

The same situation applies to that phase of the conference dealing with Indochina. In addition to the four nations represented at Berlin, other interested parties will participate, including Communist China, whose interest stems from its moral and material support of Ho Chi Minh's rebel forces. The basis of the conference will be the same as that in the Korean phase. We will be dealing with it on a strictly limited subject where the Peiping regime is necessarily a party at interest through its aggressive intervention.

In order to make it explicit that in participating in the conference at Geneva with representa-

[1] Address made before the China Committee of the National Council of the Churches of Christ in the U.S.A., New York, N. Y., on Mar. 24.

[2] BULLETIN of Sept. 14, 1953, p. 366.

tives of Peiping the United States will not be deviating in any respect from its policy of nonrecognition of Red China, the following statement was incorporated in the Berlin resolution at our insistence:

> It is understood that neither the invitation to, nor the holding of, the above-mentioned conference shall be deemed to imply diplomatic recognition in any case where it has not already been accorded.

What could be clearer than this?

I have digressed briefly on the subject of the forthcoming conference at Geneva in order to point out that our agreement to participate in this conference does not represent a departure from our policy with respect to China. This policy is based upon our appraisal of the situation which confronts us in China. Nothing happened at Berlin to alter this appraisal.

On the other hand, the conference will be a test of Communist professions and intentions, and it is the more important, therefore, that we have a thorough understanding of what the United States and its free-world partners stand for and the problems and issues the Communists pose. We must have such an understanding if we are to deal realistically with these issues with the Chinese Communists at Geneva, and to determine how, if at all, the high goals we seek to achieve with respect to Korea and Indochina can be reached there through negotiation.

The Chinese Communist Regime

What is the situation that confronts us today on the China mainland? I will describe it briefly only in terms of power.

In the 4½ years since the establishment of their regime, the Chinese Communists have with ruthless efficiency set out not only to liquidate all overt political opposition but also to eliminate sources of potential opposition. On the basis of available evidence, the Peiping regime has largely succeeded in accomplishing the first objective throughout most of China. Landlords, so-called "counter-revolutionaries," and farmers-turned-guerrillas have been slain by the millions in the process.

The regime will never succeed in the second of these objectives, of course, for virtually the whole population of the mainland will remain a source of potential opposition. Nevertheless, by such devices as the so-called "5-anti campaign," the Communists have struck heavily at social-economic groups—such as the urban middle class, for example—which they distrust and which are logical sources of potential opposition leadership. The result of these and other policies has been to consolidate the hold of the Communist regime over the mainland to a point where, for the predictable future at least, there is no prospect of its being seriously shaken by domestic opposition, however much the people may cry out in their hearts against the evil which has befallen them.

For purposes of policy determination, therefore, it must be estimated that, short of large-scale intervention, the Communist regime at Peiping will continue to exercise effective control over the mainland and to utilize the human and material resources of that vast area to increase its own power.

If this assumption is correct, it then becomes a matter of urgent concern to us to estimate how Peiping may be expected to use this power derived from its control of the Chinese mainland. The record shows that it will be used to serve the interests of the Soviet bloc, which the regime identifies with its own.

At the very outset, the Mao regime declared that it was by choice in the Soviet camp, announcing that it would pursue a "lean to one side" policy in foreign affairs—one of the greatest understatements of the ages. The alacrity with which the Soviet Union and its satellites recognized the new regime indicated that this policy came as no surprise to them and attested to their conviction that the new regime was genuinely Communist. Thus the Peiping regime, which was established on October 1, 1949, was notified on October 2 by the U.S.S.R. of its decision to establish diplomatic relations.

This was accomplished the very next day, and the Soviet's Eastern European satellites, Bulgaria, Rumania, Hungary, Czechoslovakia, and Poland, dutifully followed suit on October 4, 5, 6, and 7, respectively. The North Korean regime, the East German Communist satellite, and the so-called "Peoples Republic of Mongolia," which is legitimately Chinese territory, also established diplomatic relations with the Peiping regime during the first month of its existence.

Since then, the Chinese Communist regime has progressively strengthened its ties with the Soviet Union and other Communist states through various treaties and agreements. For example, on February 16, 1950, it concluded with Moscow a so-called "Sino-Soviet Treaty of Friendship, Alliance, and Mutual Assistance"; an agreement on the Chang Chun Railroad, Port Arthur, and Dairen; and an agreement on the grant of credit. This event was followed by conclusion of a barter agreement with Poland on March 1, a barter agreement with the Soviet Union on April 19, a trade agreement with East Germany on October 10. In subsequent years it has concluded agreements with the other satellite states.

Spread of Soviet Influence

But Peiping has not been content simply with strengthening its external ties with the Soviet Union and its satellites. It has actively introduced Soviet influence into China itself. Thus thousands of Soviet advisers in diverse fields have been brought in by the Mao regime following its conclusion with Moscow, on March 27, 1950, of "an agreement for the enlistment of the services

of Soviet experts by China." These Soviet advisers play an important role in shaping Red China's economic life and building its military establishment along Soviet lines.

In order to facilitate the spread of Soviet influence, the teaching of the Russian language has been vigorously pushed and will become compulsory in all middle schools as soon as the supply of teachers permits. Soviet political and cultural writings have also been translated in large numbers and distributed widely. According to the Chinese Communist publication *A Guide to New China* (1953 edition), the Sino-Soviet Friendship Association, which was established less than a week after the Peiping regime itself and now claims a membership of over 68 million, had by the end of September 1952 published 91 periodicals and 1,990 booklets, with a total circulation of over 14,600,000 copies, had given 35,518 moving picture shows to a total audience of 37,700,000, and had arranged 29,769 photographic exhibitions visited by 81,400,000 people.

The *Guide* describes the Sino-Soviet Friendship Association as "a vast organization whose aim is to further and to consolidate a fraternal friendship and cooperation between the Chinese and Soviet peoples and to develop interflow of knowledge and experience of the two great nations." From all appearances, however, the alleged interflow of knowledge and experience is principally a one-way thoroughfare for the spread of Soviet influence in every walk of life on the mainland of China.

In effect, China is being deliberately and systematically swamped by alien Soviet ideas, values, institutions, and practices. While the Peiping regime has thus integrated itself more and more closely with the Soviet bloc externally and deliberately intensified Soviet influence within China, it has at the same time assumed a posture of open hostility toward the West, especially the United States, and energetically sought to root out every vestige of Western cultural, economic, and political influence from the mainland. I do not have to elaborate this point before this audience, or remind you that in the process many of your colleagues, both Chinese and foreign, have suffered serious personal injury and abuse. There are still 32 Americans incarcerated in Chinese Communist prisons.

The motivation of the Chinese Communist leaders in closing down American missions, colleges, schools, and cultural institutes is not difficult to understand, of course. The message which these institutions brought, the teachings which they spread, were incompatible with the materialistic, state-supremacy ideology of the new masters at Peiping. Nor can one be surprised that the business enterprises of the Western democracies should be so heavily taxed and so circumscribed by restrictions as to make them inoperable, for the economic theories of the Peiping regime envisage the total control of the economic life of the country by the state.

Aggression in Korea

The full significance in terms of balance-of-power relationships in the Far East of Mao Tse-tung's transformation of the Chinese mainland into a gigantic Communist base was painfully brought home to the world in November 1950, when Chinese Communist troops by the hundreds of thousands poured into Korea and engaged United Nations and Republic of Korea forces in combat. Like their North Korean allies, the Chinese Communist armies were continuously supplied with Soviet equipment. This event demonstrated beyond question not only the solidity of the Peiping regime's alinement with the Communist bloc but also its willingness and ability to resort to open aggression in pursuit of bloc objectives. If there had been any doubt previously about the nature of the Mao regime, it was eliminated by Communist China's intervention in Korea.

For this act it was justly condemned as an aggressor by the United Nations General Assembly.

But is there reason to believe that the cessation of hostilities in Korea has changed this picture?

Thus far, unfortunately, there has been no indication that the Peiping regime, since the conclusion of the Korean Armistice Agreement on July 27, 1953, has changed its international outlook in any significant respect. The regime has continued its violent hate campaign against the United States and various Asian and Western Governments associated with it; it has continued to support the Communist-led Viet Minh rebels against the legitimate Governments of Viet-Nam, Cambodia, and Laos; it has continued to give covert encouragement and support to Communist guerrillas and other subversive groups in Southeast Asian countries; and it has persisted in its gross mistreatment of foreign nationals whom it has detained.

In short, the Peiping regime has failed to make a single move since the Armistice Agreement was signed in Korea to indicate that the policies which led to its aggression in Korea have been abandoned. Signature of the Armistice Agreement by the Chinese Communists did not in itself represent a shift in policy but only in tactics, a shift caused by the failure of previous tactics in the face of the heroic defense of its homeland by the Republic of Korea's army with the decisive assistance of United Nations forces. Thus the Communists ceased hostilities in Korea for practical not for moral reasons or because their objectives had changed.

The behavior of the Chinese Communists with respect to the Armistice Agreement itself, in fact, affords another insight into the nature of their policies. I will cite three examples briefly:

First, the Armistice Agreement provisions which enable the Neutral Nations Supervisory Commission to supervise the implementation of the armistice behind the lines have been effectively bypassed by the Communists, so that the Neutral Nations Supervisory Commission has been unable to fulfill its proper function in North Korea.

Secondly, at Panmunjom, during the negotiations in which I took part, the Communists made proposals which blandly ignored the clear intent of paragraph 60 regarding the holding of the political conference, both with respect to the composition of the conference and to its agenda. They had either changed their minds since signing the agreement or had no intention of adhering to the terms of paragraph 60 when they signed it.

A third and even more flagrant case of abuse of the Armistice Agreement was their action related to the nonrepatriate prisoners of war. When, in the first few days of explanations to the prisoners of war, it became apparent that only a small fraction would agree to return to the Communist side, the Communists preferred to block the whole procedure of explanations and distort the terms of reference rather than be faced with daily humiliation.

In all three cases, Peiping's written word meant nothing as soon as it became advantageous to violate it. Peiping could hardly have chosen a better way to demonstrate that it has not changed its policies since the armistice.

To sum up the mainland situation, we must estimate that not only will the Peiping regime maintain effective control of the mainland but it will remain firmly alined with Moscow and will continue to pursue objectives inimical to the United States and all free nations by any means at its disposal, including armed aggression when feasible.

Importance of Formosa

Turning now to Formosa, we find that it occupies an importance in our appraisal of the China scene greatly out of proportion to its size and resources, because it is the seat of the legitimate Government of China. Since it was driven from the mainland by Communist power, the Government of the Republic of China has not only succeeded in surviving but has grown in strength and stability.

Strategically, the Island of Formosa, defended by a steadily improving military establishment some ½ million strong, is a major obstacle to further Communist military expansion in the Pacific. Because the military forces on Formosa are composed of Chinese imbued with a desire to liberate their fellow countrymen on the mainland, they possess, in addition to their intrinsic military value, a psychological importance for China greater than a comparable force of another nationality. Thus, while it would be unwise to overestimate the strength of the free Chinese forces on Formosa in the face of the formidable military power of the mainland, they are nevertheless an indispensable asset to free-world defenses in the Pacific.

Perhaps of more importance, however, than the military capabilities of Free China are its political potentialities. The very existence of the Government of the Republic of China on Formosa symbolizes the significant fact that communism has not won a total victory in China. During the 4½ years that it has governed from Taipei, important strides have been made in the economic and governmental administration spheres, demonstrating that the Chinese Government has a capacity for growth and improvement, and providing confidence that it will continue to develop on Formosa a free Chinese society which will stand in increasingly favorable contrast to the regimented and oppressed society of the mainland. By fulfilling this role, it will attract growing support and allegiance from the Chinese people everywhere.

The Chinese Government on Formosa also provides the Chinese people with a representative voice in the United Nations and in other international forums, and with a channel of continuing contact with the peoples of the free world. It has consistently supported the objectives of the United Nations and other international bodies to which it belongs, and thereby has assumed a posture in world affairs more truly representative of the desires of the Chinese people than the defiant and aggressive regime in Peiping. In sum, we must estimate that for the sake of the Chinese people, as well as in our own interest, we must continue to recognize the Government of the Republic of China as the rightful Government of China and to give it our financial, diplomatic, and military support.

The 13 million overseas Chinese are an important element of the China picture in their own right. It should not be forgotten that overseas Chinese support of Sun Yat-sen contributed significantly to the ultimate overthrow of the Manchu dynasty. Once again the overseas Chinese communities may make an important contribution to the cause of freedom.

The role of the overseas Chinese is given added significance by the active, and sometimes effective, efforts (particularly in the case of the youth) of the Chinese Communists to penetrate their communities and to make tools of them. In countries which have recognized the Peiping regime this effort is facilitated by the inducements and pressures which Peiping can exert on the overseas Chinese through its diplomatic and consular officials.

On balance, however, Peiping has lost ground in the overseas Chinese communities, at least in terms of the numbers of its supporters. This may be attributed in part to the excesses of the regime

during the past 2 or 3 years, particularly in its attacks against the merchant class. It may also be due to the fact that several of the Southeast Asian states, where most of the overseas Chinese are concentrated and form potent minorities, have taken measures to discourage local Chinese political activity and have increased their efforts to integrate these alien communities with the indigenous population. To the extent that such measures are successful they will also tend to diminish the support which the Republic of China can expect to receive from the overseas Chinese. Nevertheless, these communities remain an important potential source of moral and financial aid to the cause of Chinese freedom, and of strength in the countries in which they reside.

Our Use of Freedom

In these few minutes I have tried to describe for you the main elements in the China scene as we face it today. It is in the light of these elements that our policy toward China is formulated. On the wisdom, firmness, and consistency of this policy will depend in large measure the ability of the free nations in Asia to maintain their freedom, and the ultimate hope of the Chinese people to regain theirs.

In view of the situation on the Chinese mainland today, we have no choice but to maintain strong military forces at home and in the Pacific, and to assist other nations in the Far East, including Free China, to build up their defenses, if freedom is to be preserved.

The ultimate success of our policy toward China, or toward any area of the world for that matter, does not rest merely on the preservation of freedom, however, but also on our constructive utilization of freedom. Secretary Dulles has said:

> **The fundamental, on our side, is the richness—spiritual, intellectual and material—that freedom can produce and the irresistible attraction it then sets up.**

I think it is significant that Mr. Dulles put spiritual richness first. The most constructive use to which we can put our freedom is the development of spiritual richness. Freedom thus used will exert its irresistible attraction in the great struggle for the hearts and minds of men in which we are engaged.

But if this is true, it behooves us Americans to give profound attention to our own spiritual foundations. As a Nation we must follow the example of the man described in the eighth chapter of Matthew, who built his house upon a rock. We know that the Communists are building their house on the sands of atheism, materialism, and the degradation of the human spirit, and great will be the fall thereof. But we must beware lest our house fall too. We must build it upon rock—the rock of faith. This is the consideration which transcends in importance all other elements in the formulation of our China policy.

U.S.-Japanese Friendship

by Walter S. Robertson
Assistant Secretary for Far Eastern Affairs[1]

The friendship between Japan and the United States is 100 years old today. The magnificent stone lantern—itself three times that age—which stands here beside us was given to our capital city by the people of the capital city of Japan to commemorate the event with which that friendship began. That event was the conclusion of the treaty of Kanagawa, which was signed for the United States by Commodore Matthew C. Perry.

It is conventional to point out that the visit of Commodore Perry's squadron to the harbor of Uraga brought to an end the long period of Japan's seclusion.

Perhaps it may also, however, be said to have foreshadowed the end of our own detachment from world affairs. From the event of precisely 100 years ago that we are celebrating today may well be dated the synchronous rise of Japan and the United States to the condition of world powers. This is a condition our two peoples have by no means entirely desired or always enjoyed. The isolation to which we both clung in the past out of suspicion and fear of more powerful nations across the seas has never entirely lost its attractions for us. When the trials and difficulties of decision that go with great nationhood have sorely beset us, we have looked back with nostalgia upon the happy days when it seemed possible to exclude the world from our shores.

For both countries, however, isolation has always been a vain dream. The character of the Japanese and American peoples—their capacity for hard work, their vigor, their ingenuity and scientific aptitudes—and the stimulus given to the exercise of these qualities by the character of the lands the two peoples inhabit made certain that the two countries would win places of influence in the world and would bear great responsibility for the future of 20th century civilization.

Since the bearing of such responsibility is so notably the common destiny of our two nations today, each people can be grateful that it has the other for its friend.

The long association of Japan and the United States has been marked by outstanding acts of generosity on both sides. Each people has helped the other when natural disaster has struck. It has been marked also by one tragic and terrible conflict. But all our shared experiences, happy and unhappy together, have, in their ultimate effect, tended to draw us together. I believe it can fairly be said that our two peoples have come to understand each other. This understanding bridges the vast waters of the Pacific and a great

[1] Address made at Washington, D. C., on Mar. 30 (press release 167).